

Statistical Guide for the Dr James Moroka Football team
Team Report
Tournament Report
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The Purpose of this report is to provide you the management of the DR James Moroka football team with insight into football stats which will help in preparation of the tournament. This document will contain analysis from the most recent FIFA world cup which took place during the year 2022. This data has been analysed to show winning strategies and provide a statistical roadmap to the players and coaches to understand what objectives are needed to become a successful team., Note: THIS IS NOT A GUARANTEED WINNING STRATEGY, but one to help when making game plans and creating line-ups.

Analysis 1: High-Scoring vs Low-Scoring Matches

So, our analysis begins with us looking at the games with the most goals in the FIFA world cup and the ones with lowest goals. We did this because these are the results we are trying to replicate within our very own team. Football logic tells us the team that scores the most goals within 90 minutes will win the game and that should be the goal of the team. Once we find the statistics for the high scoring games this will then enable us to emulate and chase similar stats to achieve success during tournament football.

Some of the games which had the highest scoring were

- Argentina vs Netherlands
- Argentina vs France
- Brazil vs Croatia
- Costa Rica vs Spain
- England vs Iran

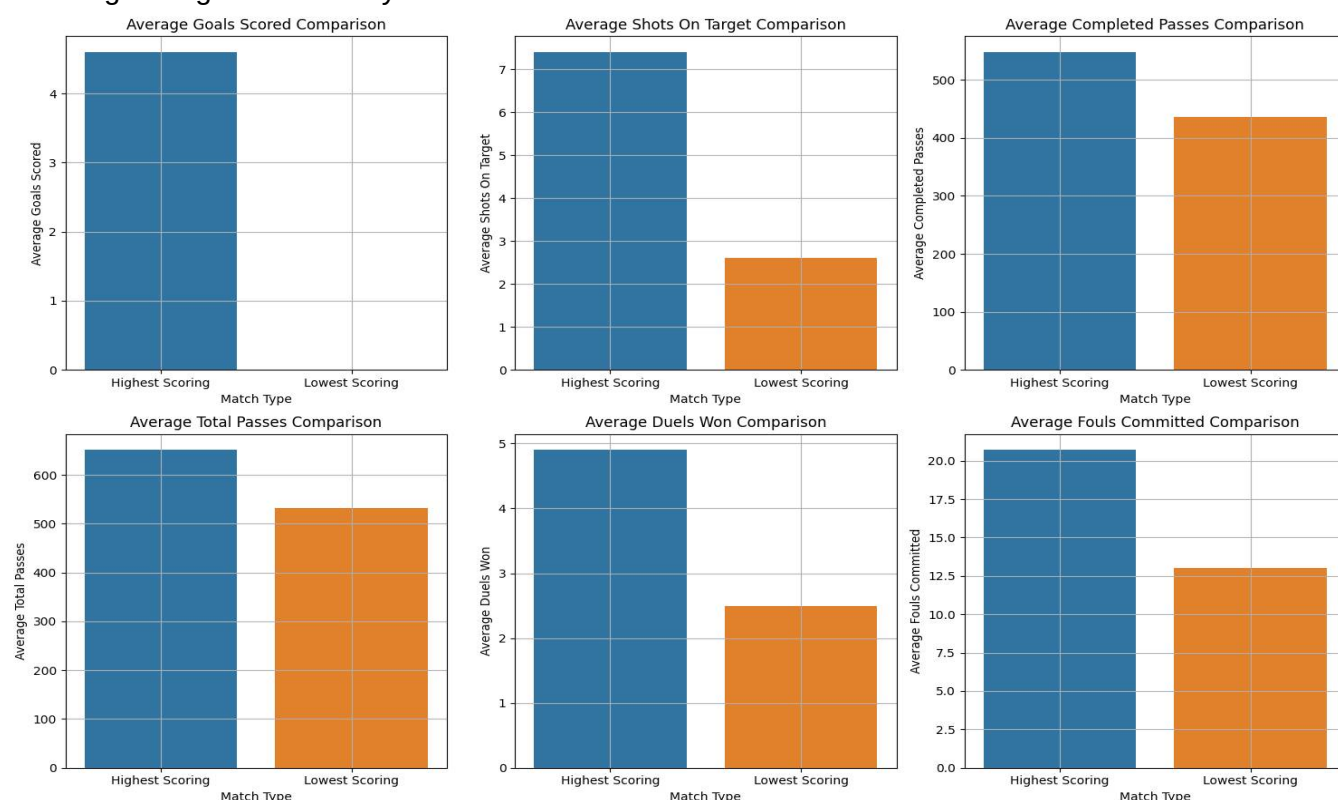
Once these games were found the same was done for games containing the lowest scores. The games included matches such as:

- Belgium vs Croatia
- Croatia vs Morocco
- England vs United States
- Mexico vs Poland
- Denmark vs Tunisia

From this separation of games, we witness that Croatia even though having a game in the high scoring threshold also is the only team to appear twice in the lowest scoring games list.

Now that we have a few games from the highest scoring games and the lowest scoring games let's find the average stats for different metrics to find out what an average game should look like if the team were to ever have high scoring matches.

The Chart below represents the data of the averages of the different metrics that we will be following throughout the analysis.



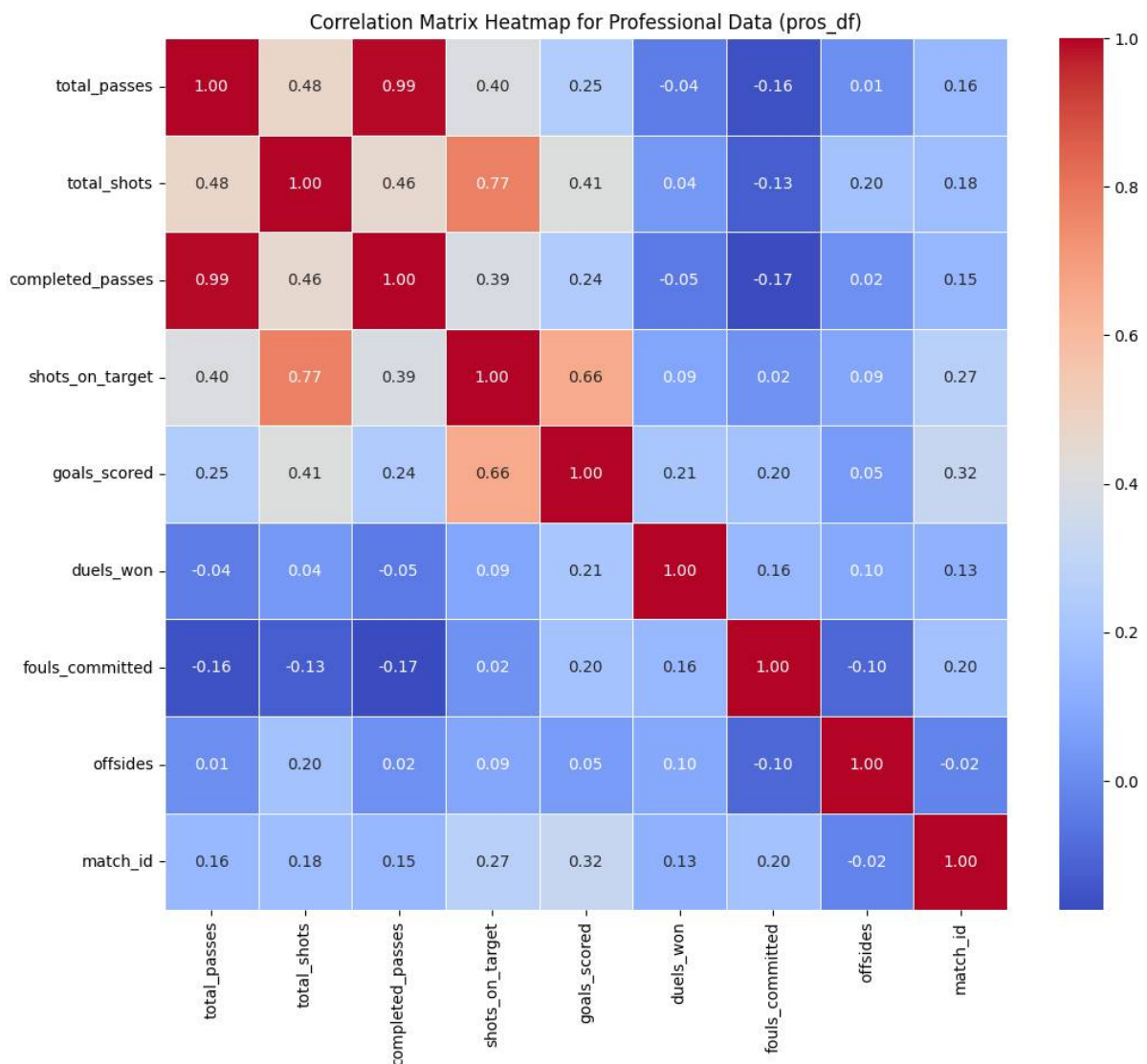
From the world cup data statistics such as shots taken, shots on target and duels won are high for high scoring games which is something that we can take into account if we want to replicate the high scoring games and finish our matches with high scores. We need to have players who are aware and understand they need to win their duels which means a practise session where marking and pressing could be incorporated, shots on target as well, practises could focus on making sure attackers and midfielders are aware they need to create the most chances and be accurate when taking shots because the more shots we have on target the more goal scoring opportunities will be presented to the team. The relationship of shots on target and goals scored will be explored later during this analysis.

Analysis 2: Key Metric Relationships

The next step was to find relationships between the different metrics of our data. Through this analysis I have decided to take an approach that will focus on a metric to the goals scored therefore the goals scored metric will be a 'dependent variable'.

We firstly recognise:

There's a 66% relationship with shots on target and goals scored which is a strong indication that the more a team attempts shots at goal the more likely they are to succeed, at first glance this might seem obvious but when quantified these numbers show the true importance of having your own players have an opportunity at goal. This is said because of the tendency of teams trying to play around the box and find the safer shots but in my subjective view if risks are taken and more shots are taken at the goal keep the more likely you are to have the ball at the back of the net.



Shots on Target and Goals Scored

The data revealed a 66% relationship between shots on target and goals scored. Teams that consistently place shots on target are significantly more likely to score.

With that being said a search was done to find the teams the most shots on target in the world cup.

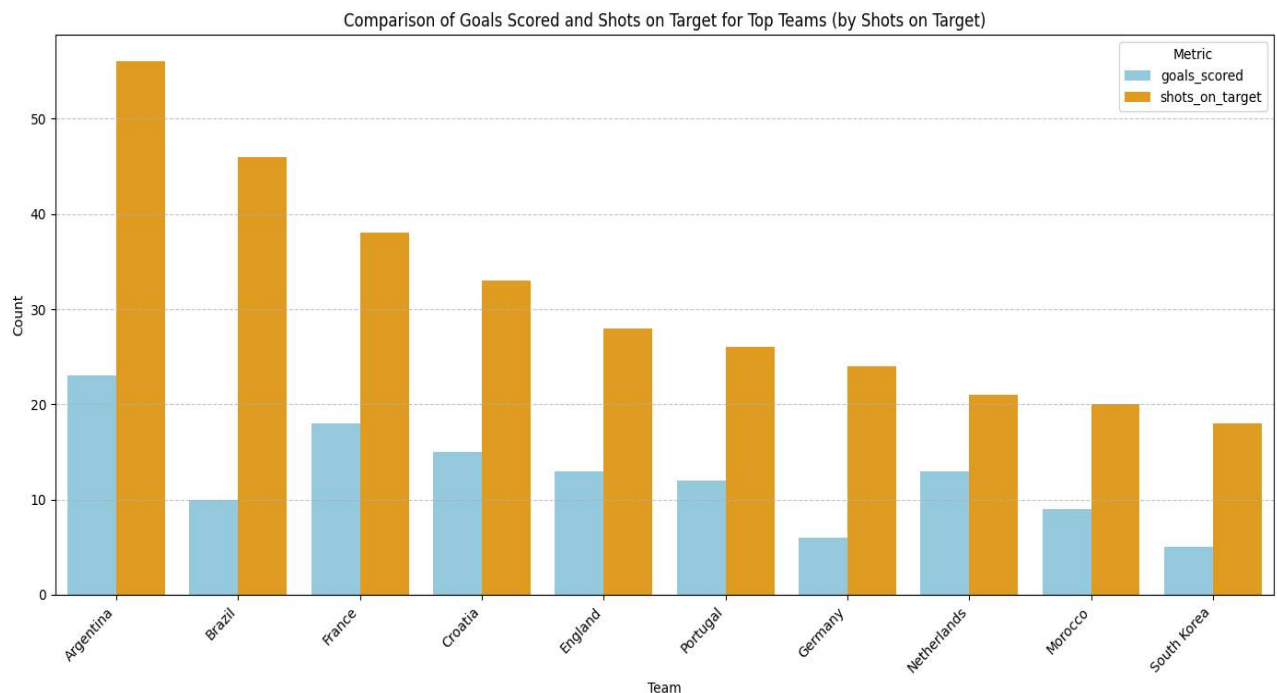
Total shots on target per team in World cup data:

0	Argentina	56.0
3	Brazil	46.0
11	France	38.0
7	Croatia	33.0
10	England	28.0
20	Portugal	26.0
12	Germany	24.0
18	Netherlands	21.0
17	Morocco	20.0
25	South Korea	18.0

Once we found these teams, we had another search done to find the total goals these teams had scored throughout the tournament. The goals were obtained and used for a bar plot to represent the data graphically.

Total goals scored for top 10 teams by shots on target:

	team	goals scored
0	Argentina	23.0
4	France	18.0
2	Croatia	15.0
3	England	13.0
7	Netherlands	13.0
8	Portugal	12.0
1	Brazil	10.0
6	Morocco	9.0
5	Germany	6.0
9	South Korea	5.0



So, from our data we clearly see that the team with the most shots on target got the most goals scored which was Argentina which went on to win the tournament. Followed by second place France, third place Croatia, Morocco, Portugal, Brazil and England as well as the Netherlands. These teams all have one thing in common which is they all made the quarter finals of the tournament.

Now that we have seen the teams with the most shots on target and the goals they have scored, we found the teams with the most goals regardless of any other stat to support it. This was done to find out how many of the teams from the first top 10 list would make this new one.

Top 10 teams by total goals scored:

	team	goals scored
0	Argentina	23.0
11	France	18.0
7	Croatia	15.0
10	England	13.0
18	Netherlands	13.0
20	Portugal	12.0
3	Brazil	10.0
17	Morocco	9.0
26	Spain	9.0
15	Japan	6.0

After viewing we see that 80% of the teams which made the top 10 shots on the target list made the list for total goals scored throughout the tournament Furthermore solidifying the strong relationship between shots on target and goals scored so therefore coaches can take an approach to adjust strategies for the tournament to create as many possible chances for players to have shots which will in turn increase the probability of the goals scored.

Duels Won and Goals Scored

Winning duels improves a team's ability to regain possession and create attacking opportunities. Teams such as Croatia, France, Argentina, and the Netherlands ranked highly in this metric.

Next another deep dive was done for duels won to goals scored this similar to what we did above.

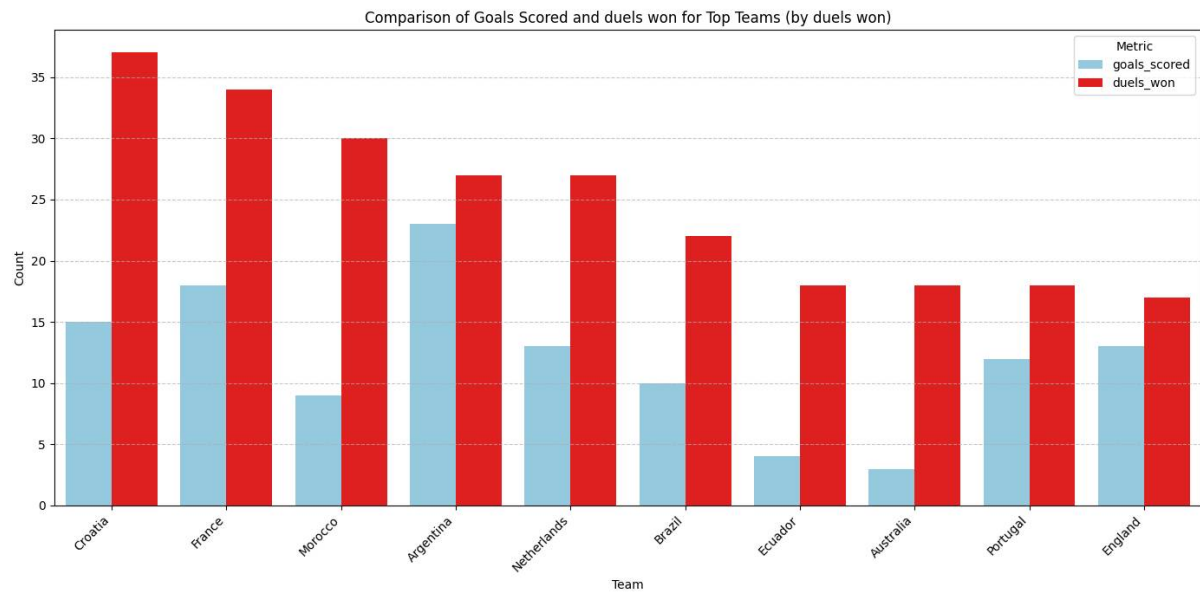
Top 10 teams by duels won:

	team	duels won
7	Croatia	37.0
11	France	34.0
17	Morocco	30.0
0	Argentina	27.0
18	Netherlands	27.0
3	Brazil	22.0
9	Ecuador	18.0
1	Australia	18.0
20	Portugal	18.0
10	England	17.0

Total goals scored for top 10 teams by duels won:

	team	goals scored
0	Argentina	23.0
6	France	18.0
3	Croatia	15.0
8	Netherlands	13.0
5	England	13.0
9	Portugal	12.0
2	Brazil	10.0
7	Morocco	9.0
4	Ecuador	4.0
1	Australia	3.0

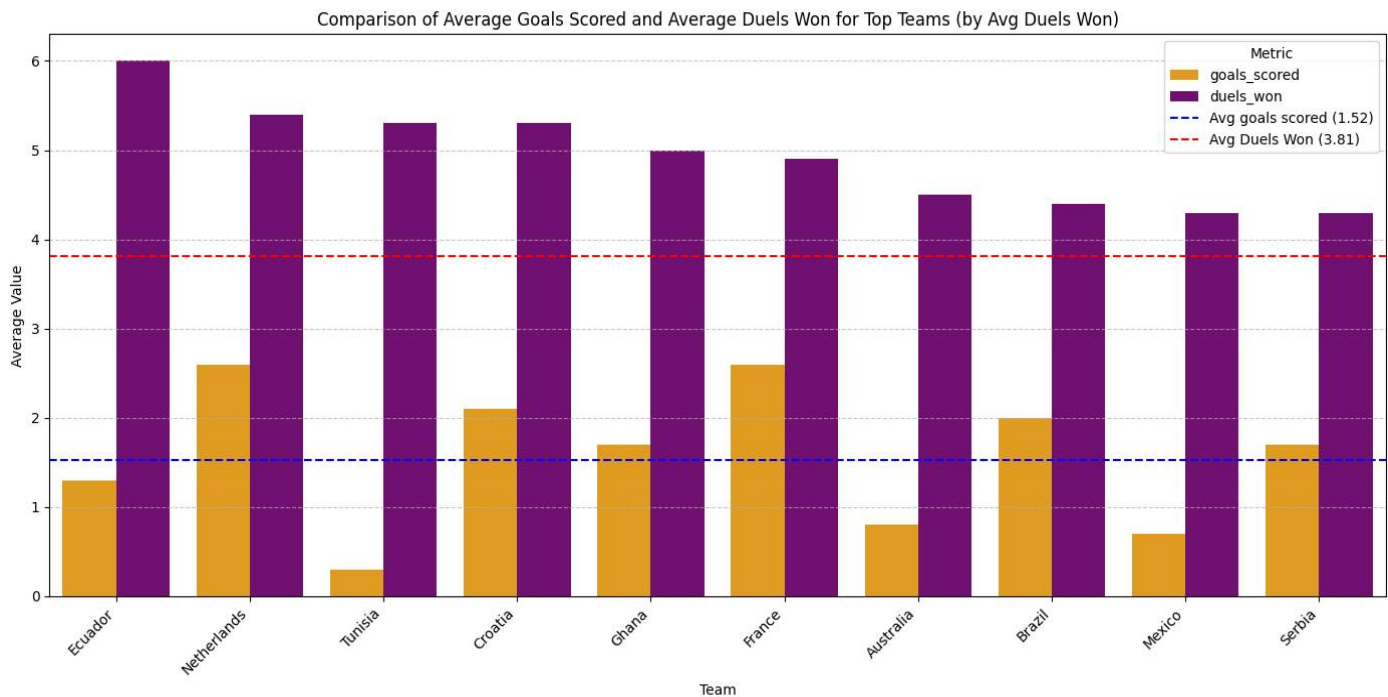
The graph below represents the total duels won and total goals scored by teams in the top ten list for total duels won.



These stats were great but another deep dive was done to find average duels won per game this meant to show us on a per game level which teams were actually efficient at winning the ball back to create goal scoring opportunities. This analysis was great because it shows us teams like Netherlands, Croatia, Ghana, France, Brazil and Serbia who managed to retain the ball and create scoring chances to average high scoring games as these are the only teams to cross both the average duels won line and the average goals scored.

These figures were good but I figured the team also needed the per game averages for duels won. So next the average duels and goals scored by the teams which ranked top 10 for total duels won was obtained.

The graph below represents the Average duels won and average goals scored by teams in the top ten list for total duels won.



There are only few teams who passed the average for goals scored and duels won which are:

- The Netherlands
- Croatia
- Ghana
- France
- Brazil
- Serbia

These teams performed well when it came to goal scoring and ball retention. Which is something coaches can take into account when implementing strategies where the team won't have the most ball possession.

Completed Passes and Possession Control

Next, I looked at the teams with the most completed passes and before we go on, I'd like to clarify we looked at shots on target and completed passes because these are the completed stats of shots taken and attempted passes metrics. The two stats used represent the other two stats on a completed range.

I found the teams with the most completed passes and the list of teams at this point started getting recognizable. Teams like Argentina, Croatia, France, England and the Netherlands started showing up more and more thus leading me to believe they had the winning formula and their play style was most efficient to achieve the statistical numbers wanted by the DR James Moroka football team.

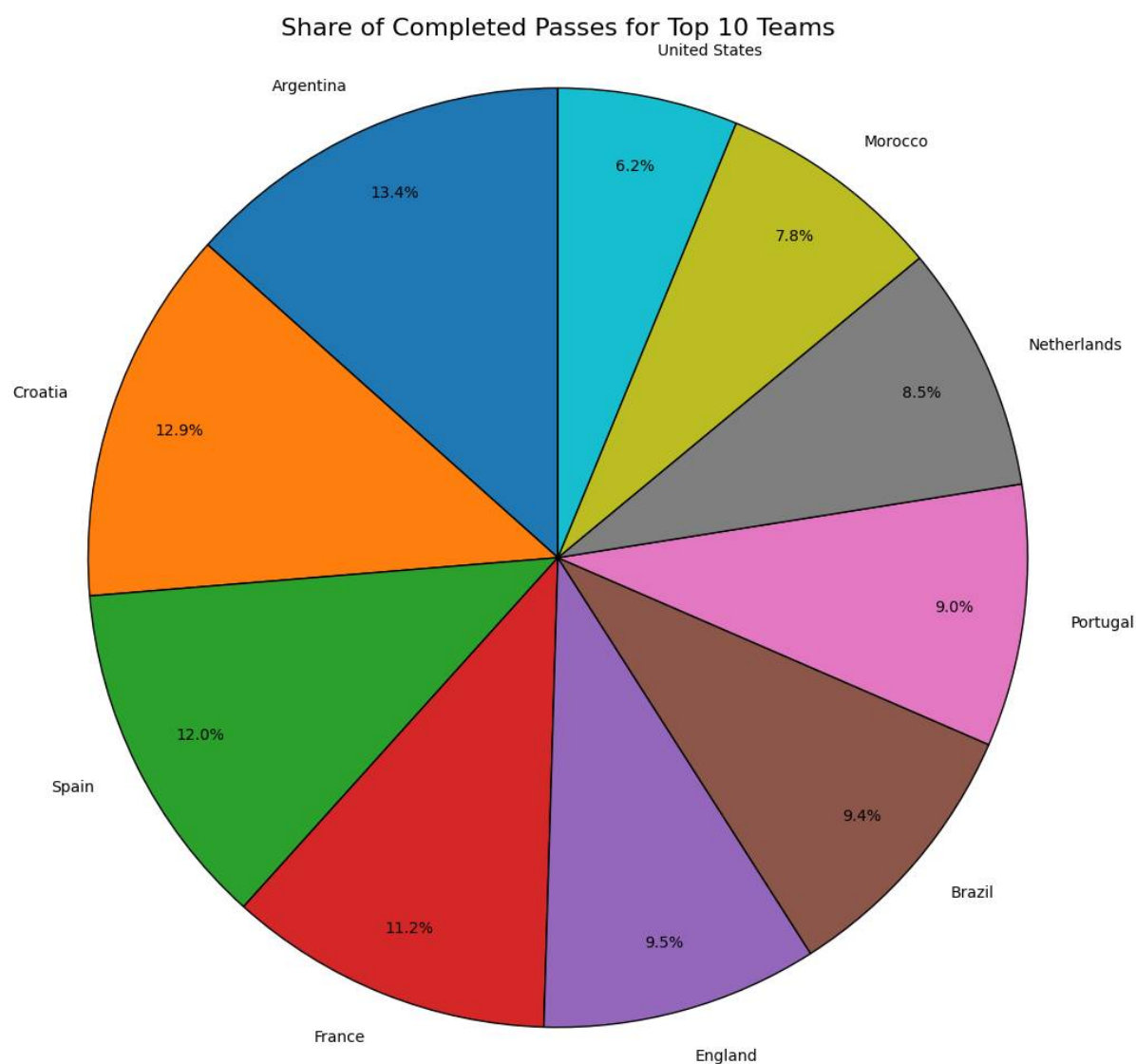
Top 10 teams by completed passes:

	team	completed passes
0	Argentina	3939.0
7	Croatia	3796.0
26	Spain	3540.0
11	France	3291.0
10	England	2800.0
3	Brazil	2776.0
20	Portugal	2655.0
18	Netherlands	2501.0
17	Morocco	2292.0
29	United States	1822.0

As we have done before, the total passes won't help but the average completed passes will be very beneficial because they'll give us an achievable goal for the team.

Average completed passes and goals scored for top 10 teams by total completed passes:

	team	avg_completed_passes	avg_goals_scored
0	Argentina	562.7	3.3
1	Brazil	555.2	2.0
2	Croatia	542.3	2.1
3	England	560.0	2.6
4	France	470.1	2.6
5	Morocco	327.4	1.3
6	Netherlands	500.2	2.6
7	Portugal	531.0	2.4
8	Spain	885.0	2.2
9	United States	455.5	0.8



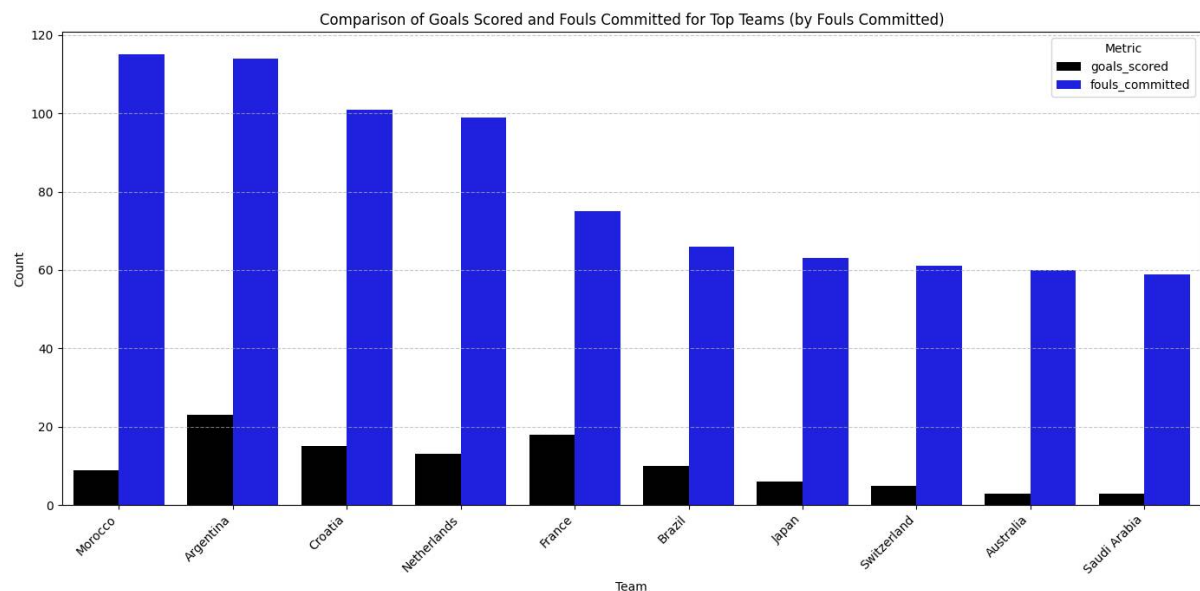
From the graph we see the share percentage from each team and how much dominance they have over the completed passes top 10 list.

Fouls and Defensive Pressure

The next metric we looked at was fouls committed and this metric was important because in my analysis I point out that fouls committed and duels won have a direct correlation as the more times a team attempts to win the ball the more likely they are to commit fouls. On our correlation metrics heatmap there is a cold relationship but sometimes the figures don't reflect the actual game as handballs and off ball actions can also result in a foul but in this analysis, we will only focus on the man marking fouls.

Top 10 teams by fouls committed:		
	team	fouls committed
17	Morocco	115.0
0	Argentina	114.0
7	Croatia	101.0
18	Netherlands	99.0
11	France	75.0
3	Brazil	66.0
15	Japan	63.0
27	Switzerland	61.0
1	Australia	60.0
22	Saudi Arabia	59.0

From the teams in the top 10 for fouls committed 70% of the teams also appear on the most duels won top 10 list as well. This metric is very important as ball retention for any team as most strategies involve the team holding most ball possession as well as the Dr James Moroka football team's very own.



The graph above shows the goals scored and the fouls committed by each team. This graph is good but doesn't show us the full picture as the fouls per game will start showing us, this will in turn show us for the comfortability for the team on how much fouls can we take per

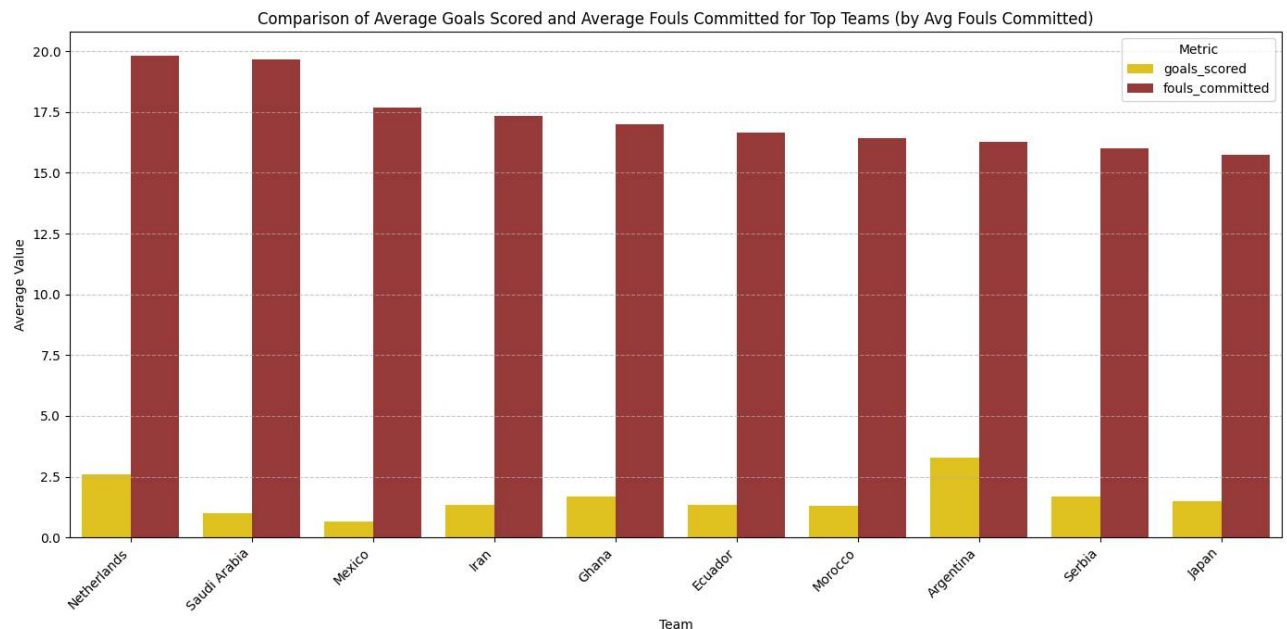
game and how many fouls can we be comfortable with this can be used hand in hand with checking the average fouls for a high scoring game.

Below we see that the Netherlands averaged the most fouls per game at 19.8 fouls committed every game they played in the tournament. The average fouls committed for a high scoring game is just above 20 fouls per game.

Top 10 teams by average fouls committed:

	team	fouls committed
18	Netherlands	19.800000
22	Saudi Arabia	19.666667
16	Mexico	17.666667
14	Iran	17.333333
13	Ghana	17.000000
9	Ecuador	16.666667
17	Morocco	16.428571
0	Argentina	16.285714
24	Serbia	16.000000
15	Japan	15.750000

The graph below shows us the average goals and average fouls committed in a game by the teams that reached the top 10 most fouls list.



Offsides and Attacking Behaviour

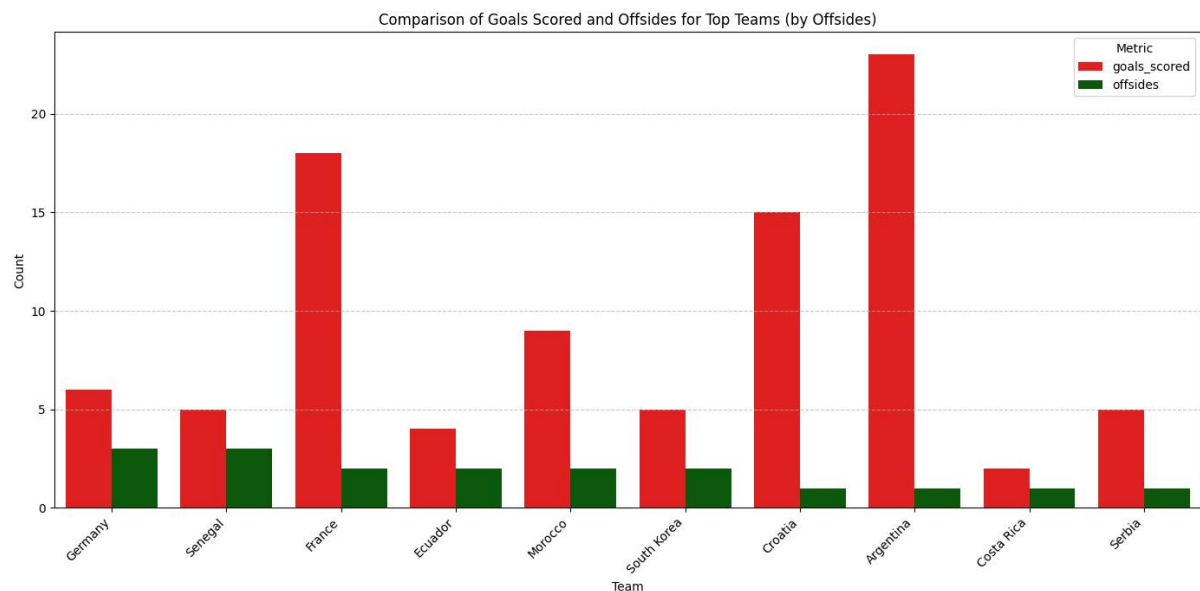
To complete the analysis, we looked at offsides committed and like fouls committed this also in turn tells us a story as I believe that a team committing offsides is a team that is attacking based and is looking to score goals.

Below we see the teams in the top 10 list for offsides committed, 40% of them were on the top 10 goals scored list, and 60% of them were on the top 10 list for shots on target.

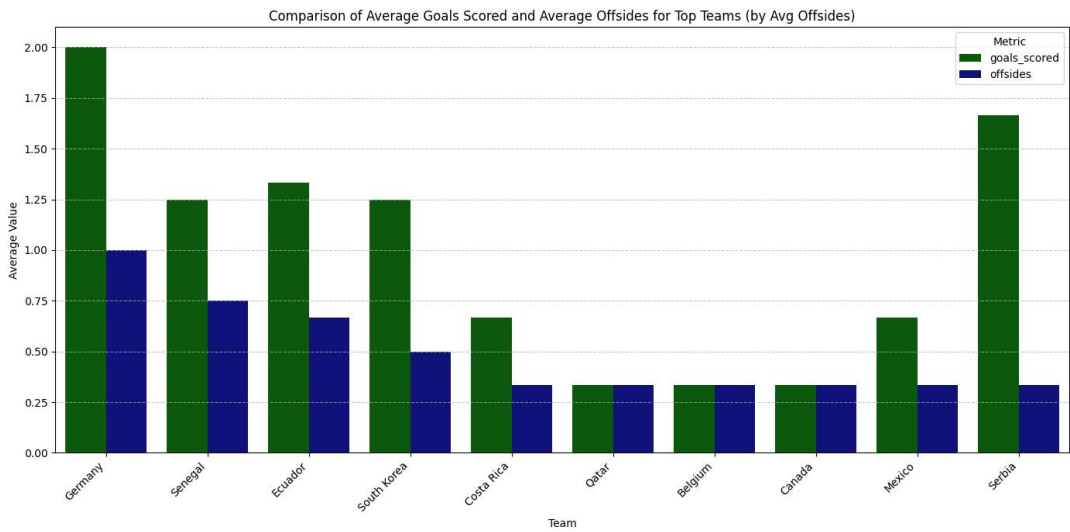
Top 10 teams by offsides:

	team	offsides
12	Germany	3.0
23	Senegal	3.0
11	France	2.0
9	Ecuador	2.0
17	Morocco	2.0
25	South Korea	2.0
7	Croatia	1.0
0	Argentina	1.0
6	Costa Rica	1.0
24	Serbia	1.0

Below is the graph showing the team and their committed offsides and the goals scored.



This graph like most of them will be accompanied by the average offsides and the average goals scored by that team.



Research

Argentina (El Albiceleste)

The Research will begin with Argentina who are the world cup winners.

This is the team that went on to win the whole tournament.

Formations

Argentina's first game involved them lining up using a 4-4-2 Where they lost 2-1 against Saudi Arabia but don't let the score line deceive you, they had 69% possession of the ball, 15 shots attempt which 6 were on target to 3 shots their opponents attempted which only 2 were on target. 507 accurate passes made and 8 duels won. They statistically dominated the game but of course in football the numbers do not always reflect the score line. This is also a warning to the reader that just because you dominated statistically does not mean you will end up winning the game there's more to the game than just stats.



4-4-2

	Lautaro Martínez		L. Messi
P. Gómez	L. Paredes	R. De Paul	Á. Di María
N. Tagliafico	N. Otamendi	C. Romero	N. Molina
	E. Martínez		



4-3-3

Á. Di María	J. Álvarez	L. Messi	
E. Fernández	A. Mac Allister	R. De Paul	
N. Tagliafico	N. Otamendi	C. Romero	N. Molina
E. Martínez			

For their final game they used a 4-3-3 which they used 3 times throughout the tournament and used the 4-4-2 3 times as well and using the 5-3-2 once against the Dutch. The team switched formations depending on who they faced. In the games they scored the most goals they lined up with the 4-3-3 but when they wanted to have more possession, they opted to overload the midfield with 4 midfielders using the 4-4-2

Netherlands

The Dutch stayed true to their philosophy and played in a 3-4-1-2 formation which gave them a good balance of defensive work and offensive press. This line-up was sound when keeping possession but one thing seen from the shots taken is that they were very dominated with shots taken against them and shots on target leading me to believe they were comfortable playing on the counter attack the concept of total football was still applied throughout the whole tournament which was introduced by Cruyff.

S.Bergwijn M. Depay
C.Gakpo
D. Blind M. de Roon F. de Jong D. Dumfries
N. Aké V. van Dijk J.Timber
A.Noppert

3-4-1-2



France

The French used the 4-2-3-1 formation which I subjectively believe is the most efficient formation to use when trying to score the most goals. They were second with the most scored goals and were third with the most shots on target and were second with most duels won and fell just below the top 5 with most duels won on average with just below 5 a game. These stats are more than just impressive they show how great of a team they were; these stats are difficult to chase because objectively France had one of the best teams in the world therefore a formation like this is to be used if the quality of attackers is high as well as that of midfielders in my own personally view. This needs players who are disciplined to attack and chase the ball and are clinically in front of goal and understand they need to take chances and not make inefficient passes.



Croatia

The Croatians used a 4-3-3 throughout the tournament and ended their last game using 4-2-3-1 formation in an attempt to sweep Morocco. They were a defensively disciplined team and as seen from the analysis retained the ball the most out of any team all competition long.



4-3-3

M. Livaja I. Perišić A. Kramarić

L. Modrić M. Kovačić M. Brozović

B. Sosa J. Gvardiol D. Lovren J. Juranović

D. Livaković

England

The England national football team (The three lions) have a high cardio and high physicality play style. Unlike the Spanish, Dutch or the Italians who have a play style centred around more technical movements the English have never really stood out for such and have never needed to as they continue to be amongst the elite in world football. The English first started their campaign using a 4-2-3-1 formation which led to a 6-2 win over the Iranians but when England started facing harder opponents, they switched formations choosing to pivot to the 4-3-3.

Line-ups



4-2-3-1

H. Kane

R. Sterling

M. Mount

B. Saka

D. Rice

J. Bellingham

L. Shaw

H. Maguire

J. Stones

K. Trippier

J. Pickford

Line-ups



4-3-3

P. Foden H. Kane B. Saka

J. Bellingham D. Rice J. Henderson

L. Shaw H. Maguire J. Stones K. Walker

J. Pickford

The English finished their run with the 4-3-3 and played the majority of their games using the formation where they eventually lost to the French in the quarter finals.

The data for strategies and formations was found using the reuters website (<https://www.reuters.com>)

Summary and Recommendations

The statistical analysis of the 2022 FIFA World Cup shows that the most successful teams combined:

- ❖ High shot accuracy
- ❖ Strong dual success
- ❖ Effective possession play
- ❖ Flexible tactical formations

While statistics cannot guarantee victory, teams that consistently achieve these metrics significantly increase their chances of scoring goals and winning matches.

By focusing on shots on target, dual dominance, and possession control, the Dr James Moroka football team can develop a strategic playing style that aligns with the patterns observed in elite international football.